

Asian CHI Symposium: HCI Research from Asia and on Asian Contexts and Cultures

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ABSTRACT

The Asian CHI symposium 2021 is the joint event organized by the researchers and practitioners in Asia. The symposium aims to bring together young and senior researchers from the academics and industries in one forum to exchange ideas and foster social network in the field of HCI. The symposium showcases the latest HCI work from Asia and those focusing on incorporating Asian sociocultural factors in their design and implementation. In addition to circulating ideas and envisioning future research in human-computer interaction, this symposium aims to foster social networks among academics (researchers and students) and practitioners and grow a research community from Asia.

CCS CONCEPTS

• **Human-centered computing**; • **Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)**;

KEYWORDS

User interfaces, Interaction design, Interactive systems, Interaction techniques, Asia

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1 INTRODUCTION

The field of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) uses insights on how social, cultural and political identities shape the way people interact with technologies. While North American and European researchers have been largely instrumental in growing what we know about the field, Asian counterparts contribute by exploring a variety of research directions and problems, expanding the applications and potential of HCI research towards culturally inclusive designs for Asian cultures and societies [1]. In par with this, Japanese researchers in particular have been pursuing interesting and unique research directions in interaction techniques and interactive systems. Due to its maturity, the Japanese HCI research community has already established well-regarded domestic conferences (“IPSJ Interaction” and “JSST Workshop on Interactive Systems and Software (WISS)”), as well as journals, accepting very-intriguing work with creative solutions on hard problems. However, Japanese researchers are finding difficulties to obtain opportunities to present their work at international venues due to different publication criteria. and moreover, creates a significant barrier for aspiring young researchers to publish or present their work in progress as they may not have sufficient experience in publishing and presenting their work at prominent international conferences. Similar context can be applied to neighboring communities in East Asia in China, South Korea and Taiwan which have mature HCI developments. Despite their flourishing domestic HCI research, they still face challenges disseminating their work in bigger international venues.

On the other hand, researchers in the global south, especially South and Southeast Asia, face a greater challenge of underrepresentation in these large venues despite reaching similar advancement in HCI research. This is because of their smaller and nascent HCI research communities with limited financial and institutional support to share their works. Thus, providing an opportunity of presenting latest research outcomes from Asia at CHI will benefit the whole wider underrepresented HCI research community, especially Asian researchers who otherwise would not attend the conference. To this end, several batches of Asian researchers have jointly organized symposiums and region-specific workshops at CHI since 2015. These were started by the Japanese, Southeast Asian and Chinese communities and the timeline reflects how these efforts have progressed over the years with much success (see Table 1). However, despite consistent efforts in growing diversity in the main and specialized conferences, research from Asia is still under-represented [2].

At CHI 2021, we plan to continue the successes of the 2020 [8] by organizing another joint event with more Asian research leaders from Japan, China, South Korea, Malaysia, Indonesia, the Philippines, Thailand, India and Sri Lanka. We also recruited ambassadors from all places including the underrepresented regions in Asia to increase participation from their home institutions and countries. Aside from increasing participation from all over Asia, we will also continue inviting esteemed and emerging HCI researchers to give keynote speeches, inspire future research, and urge participants to embark on new problems, sub-fields or methods. These actions contribute towards our mission of providing a high-quality venue for Asian HCI researchers to have international exchanges. It is also aimed to be a place for young researchers and students to interact

Table 1: Timeline of CHI venues for Asia

Year	CHI Venues
2015	Japanese CHI Symposium; Chinese CHI Symposium; Crossing HCI for Development in Asia Pacific [3]
2016	Japanese CHI Symposium; Chinese CHI 2016 Workshop; SEACHI 2016 [4]
2017	Asian CHI Symposium
2018	Asian CHI Symposium [5]; Chinese CHI 2018 Workshop
2019	Asian CHI Symposium [6]; HCI in China Workshop
2020	Asian CHI Symposium [7]; Chinese CHI 2020 Workshop

with other senior and junior colleagues. We will also continue the missions from last year that are to improve the quality of submissions to proudly present quality HCI research from Asia on the ACM Digital Library and improve the geographical diversity of the authors and the participants, which was proven to be achievable due to the new normal during the 2020 symposium.

2 EXPECTED OUTCOMES AND MEASUREMENTS

Our main objectives and key results (OKRs) can be derived as follows. Importantly, it is accommodating a fully virtual model to face unprejudicial due to COVID19 travel restrictions and hygienic concerns.

1. We aim for the number of participants to be comparable to last year which was fully virtual (163 participants directly registered with the symposium);
2. We aim to have at least 40% of the participants being young researchers (students and early-career);
3. We will continue the shepherding of near-acceptance submissions which provide ample opportunities for inexperienced researchers to upgrade their publication to a quality level. Shepherding process will be systematically designed to track the pre and post qualities of the papers selected for shepherding. With this, we aim to see significant development in quality enhancement difference in the ratings of all shepherded submissions pre- and post-shepherding (for details, see the *Call for Participation* section);
4. We aim to have a higher proportion of participants from more Asian countries, especially from Southern and Western Asia geography with aggressive ambassador programs, than in the past.

3 SYMPOSIUM DAY AND STRUCTURE

Asian CHI Symposium is the largest symposium at CHI, with 85 participants from 2019, and 163 registered participants from 2020 which was held fully online. As CHI 2021 will be fully virtual, we expect the Asian CHI Symposium to be bigger, with an estimate that 170 will be attending online. Because of the number of submissions

we typically accept, we plan to have the symposium over two days. Placing the symposium on Friday and Saturday allows a gap day before the main conference begins. Similar to the past, many participants are local chapter leaders and will be representing their local SIGCHI chapters. Having the symposium on Friday and Saturday allows them to participate in the meeting of SIGCHI Local Chapters on Sunday or other pre-CHI community activities.

3.1 Oral and Poster Presentations

With the new norm, all authors with accepted submissions are expected to present their works using online presentation on a virtual platform. There will be a “prime time” slot for each work in which its authors are expected to be presenting the work to the audience. For the rest of the sessions, authors can freely choose to listen in to other presentations in author’s track or other parallel track(s).

We plan to use Zoom webinar for the session and Discord to facilitate further discussions, as both the software possess necessary accessibility features. We will collect the pre-recorded videos from the accepted position paper presenters and play them during the session to avoid any network related issue, however, the authors will answer the questions from the audience online after their presentation.

3.2 Plenary and Keynote Speeches

In the plenary session, we will introduce activities in Asian communities and presentations from esteemed speakers who work in Asian region or Asian-related projects. Each talk will be 20-30 minutes including Q&A.

3.3 Mixers

We will provide opportunities to connect young researchers with international research communities and stimulate international collaboration. The proposed activities will be as follows, which the sessions will be live feeding to remote attendees:

- Introduction, icebreaking speed-networking
- SIGCHI Asian Development Committee presents recent activities in and related to Asia
- Keynote speeches
- Short break
- Remote oral presentations
- Interactive Social Mixer
- Long break
- Remote poster presentations
- Remote oral presentations
- Short break
- Plenary reflection and closing ceremony

4 PRE-SYMPOSIUM PLANS

We will set up a website that will host the call for papers and future programs. In addition, we will host a blog to share the missions and the process of organizing the symposium. It will serve as an organizational memory for future organizers. We will promote the symposium actively on Facebook, Twitter as well mailing lists related to SIGCHI activity postings, such as CHI-announcements, CHI-II, access-announcements, etc. Through a collaboration with

our ambassadors, we will also advertise this symposium at regional journals and conferences and in their online social networks.

5 POST-SYMPOSIUM PLANS

After the symposium, we will assess the attainment of our expected outcomes and share them with the rest of the community (see section Expected Outcomes and Measurements). We aim to summarize the experience in the Interaction magazine article.

5.1 Publication

Original submissions that are accepted to present may choose to have their camera-ready submissions to be listed in the ACM Digital Library as abstract-only, the whole extended abstract, or none at all. These options provide enough flexibility for work-in-progress submissions so that they can continue their work, and have it published later in a journal or conference. For authors who will choose to publish their whole extended abstracts, there is a shepherding post-symposium: selected mentors will closely work with authors to improve the quality of the manuscript. Only submissions that successfully go through the shepherding will be added to the ACM Digital Library.

For the showcase submissions (that will also be presented in other CHI 2021 tracks), their entry in the proceedings of the symposium will contain only the title and authors with a pointer to the corresponding entry in the CHI 2021 Proceedings or Extended Abstract Proceedings.

6 ORGANIZERS

Adi (Josh) Tedjasaputra is a Google-certified Design Sprint Master, who builds and nurtures business and innovation at UX Indonesia and Customer Experience Insight Pty Ltd. For more than 20 years, he has been helping international companies in creating business strategy, disruptive technology, marketing, and branding of successful products and services.

Dr. Briane Paul V. Samson is an Assistant Professor at De La Salle University and co-directs the Center for Complexity and Emerging Technologies (COMET). He currently works on interactive and collaborative technologies that promote civic engagement and prosocial behaviors. Recently, he’s been designing navigation applications that encourage the use of unselfish routes.

Dr. Masitah Ghazali is an Associate Professor at the School of Computing, a member of ViCubeLab Research Group, and an IT Associate Fellow at UTM Digital Department at Universiti Teknologi Malaysia (UTM). She currently works on mobile-BCI to make it more accessible to people. She is one of the founding members of ACM Kuala Lumpur Chapter and currently holds the chair position.

Dr. Eunice Sari is the CEO and the Co-founder of UX Indonesia. She is a University Research Fellow of Charles Darwin University Australia. Currently she is the ACM SIGCHI VP for Chapters and part of the Asian Development Committee for Southeast Asia. As a practitioner, Eunice is also a Google Developer Mentor in Product Design and Strategy where she leads a number of global UX projects.

Dr. Sayan Sarcar is an Assistant Professor at the University of Tsukuba, Japan. His research interests are in HCI, Aging and Accessibility and User Interface Optimization.

Dilrukshi Gamage is a PhD student at the University of Moratuwa specializing in the field of HCI and edtech. She is the founding chair of the SIGCHI Colombo chapter in Sri Lanka.

Dr. Kazuyuki Fujita is an Assistant Professor at Tohoku University. He received his Ph.D. in Information Science and Technology from Osaka University in 2013. His research interests are spatial user interface and virtual reality.

Pranjal Jain is a co-founder of theUXWhale, India. He is an alumni of Srishti Institute of Art, Design and Technology. Currently he is the Chapter Director of Startup Grind, Noida. He has been actively involved in the SIGCHI community to promote HCI in South Asia. He has served as Chair for Srishti SIGCHI Chapter.

Amit Jena is a PhD student at IITB-Monash Research Academy, India. He is affiliated to IDC School of Design, IIT Bombay, India and Faculty of IT, Monash University, Australia. His research interest is designing visualisations for the emergent users of ICTs.

Toni-Jan Keith Monserrat is a PhD candidate at the University of the Philippines Los Baños. He specializes in improving interventions on interactive platforms for learning. He loves to teach web development and web performance to new developers.

Nabila Sindi is an undergraduate research intern at KIXLAB at KAIST. Her current field of study is Computer Science and Industrial design. As a computer science student, she mainly specializes in human-computer interaction, but is also interested in software prototyping with her industrial design background.

Kaixing Zhao is a PhD candidate at IRIT, University of Toulouse, France. His research is dedicated to designing novel interaction techniques in the field of ubiquitous computing, cognitive science and especially assistive technology for people with visual impairments.

Jordan Deja is a PhD student working on computational interactions and adaptive visualizations on music learning. He is from the HICUP lab in the University of Primorska, Slovenia. He is also an Assistant Professor (on leave) from De La Salle University, Philippines.

Manvi Fotedar is an Industrial Arts and Design Practices student at Srishti Institute of Art, Design and Technology. She is currently pursuing her interests in designing technical support for the field of medicine through collaborative hackathons.

Manjiri Joshi is a Research Associate at IDC School of Design, IIT Bombay, India. Her research interests are HCI4D, text-input for Indian languages, and designing for emergent users of ICTs.

Yang Li is a Ph.D. candidate at the Center for Human-Engaged Computing, Kochi University of Technology, Japan. His research interests include Text Entry, Virtual Reality, and Interaction Design.

Zhicong Lu is a PhD candidate at DGP group, University of Toronto, Canada and will join the Department of Computer Science at the City University of Hong Kong as an Assistant Professor from January 2021. He is interested in designing systems that support social interactions.

Akihiro Matsufuji is a graduate student in System Design at the Tokyo Metropolitan University. His research interests include human robot interaction and neural networks.

Dr. Shio Miyafuji is graduated from Tokyo Institute of Technology and a research fellow of the Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS). Her research interests are spatial user interface and augmented/virtual reality.

Korok Sengupta is a Doctoral Researcher at the University of Stuttgart, Germany. His research interests are in HCI, Text Entry and Multi-modal Web Interaction.

Diksha Singh is a master student in IDC School of Design, IIT Bombay, India. She has been working on designing services to enhance the experience of attendees at hybrid satellite conferences. Experience design to encourage social interactions on virtual platforms is her design and research interest.

Simran Singh is a human-centered design graduate from Srishti Manipal Institute of Art, Design and Technology, Bangalore. As a budding design researcher, her work focuses on understanding the use-cases of emerging technologies and designing meaningful interactions for users.

Umar Taufiqulhakim is a computer science undergraduate student in KAIST, currently working as an undergraduate research intern at KIXLAB. He mainly focuses on human computer interaction research, but also interested in both software development and software testing.

We are also supported by the ten ambassadors from both academia and industry whom we identified can help in promoting the symposium.

7 CALL FOR PARTICIPATION

The Asian CHI Symposium invites latest and original HCI research papers from Asian countries and those focusing on incorporating Asian sociocultural factors in their design and implementation. The aim of the symposium is to promote its unique problems and approaches to the global community. We invite young and senior researchers and practitioners in this symposium.

7.1 Submission

This year we welcome two types of submissions; (1) Original Works, and (2) Showcase. The Original Work highlights novel works in the form of (1) completed studies or systems, (2) preliminary results, or (3) an extension or a discussion of an alternative perspective of previously published work. These submissions, can either be in the form of (1) paper (pages must be between 5-10 pages including references and acknowledgement), or (2) poster or demo (up to 4 pages including references and acknowledgement) in CHI 2021 Extended Abstract format.

The Showcase are works that will be presented at other CHI 2021 tracks. They could be presented at the symposium to broaden the dissemination of high-quality published research and to inspire applications, replications, continuation, spin-offs and collaboration. All types of submissions are not anonymized and uploaded through the website below.

7.2 Review Process

Each original submission will receive two anonymized reviews under the following criteria: originally; significance and validity. The submissions under the *showcase* category will be curated by taking into account the following factors: the number of the accepted original submissions; the geographical diversity of the attendees; and the diversity of research topics.

The symposium submission process allows all authors to get feedback to improve their research before presenting it in the symposium. We will recruit reviewers with the help from our volunteer ambassadors. This would allow us to get quality feedback for the abstract submissions. For those authors who want their submissions to be archived in the ACM Digital Library, we will enlist the help of the reviewers of accepted presentations to assist the paper for camera-ready just in time before the symposium.

7.3 Shepherd Process

At occasions when reviewers point out prominent research with empirical evidence, yet not reached the level of quality requirement for the publication, a shepherding process begins with the interest of the author to resubmit improved paper. In order to improve the paper, shepherding reviewers will be assigned to the paper to advise and monitor changes based on the requirement and finally aid authors to outcome a quality research publication.

7.4 Registration

At least one author of each accepted submission must be registered the remote attendance and presentation. All participants, both authors and audience, must register for the Asian CHI Symposium as defined by HCI 2021 committee.

7.5 Website

The symposium website is using the URL <https://asian-chi.github.io/2021>.

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